

A Windows XP balloon messages are generally a useful way to keep track of hard drive usage and this works well with most people. But there is always the odd occasion when they are an unwanted distraction. You can disable this warning completely by editing the Registry. Navigate to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer`. Right-click in the right pane and then select **New > DWORD value**. Type in “NoLowDiskSpaceCheck” and press [Enter]. Double-click on this newly created value and set its Value data to 1. Click OK and close the Registry Editor, and restart Windows. You will no longer be bothered by the low disk space warning again.

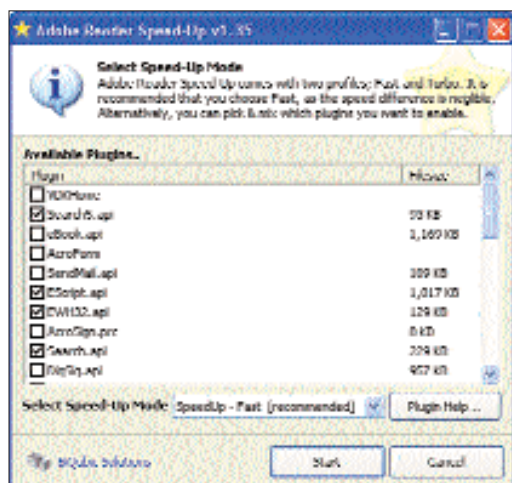
Your mail implies a very large swap file—this is overkill. Your PC isn’t going to need such a large swap file, and in its efforts to seek through it, you might actually experience performance lags. Our recommendation: set your swap file to be system-managed, and use the remaining disk space for something else—like ripping your CD collection to uncompressed audio formats.

Plugin Pain

Q My problem is that Adobe Reader takes a very long time to start up. Is there a way to speed it up?

Ali Asgar

A Adobe Reader can be a snail when it comes to starting up, because, in addition to loading the main program, it is also busy loading a ton of plugins that you may or may not need. And just for this, there is a program that lets you decide which plugins to load. This freeware program is Acrobat Reader Speed-Up, and can be downloaded from <http://tinyurl.com/symjd>. Simply download and run the program and select only those plugins you deem necessary. Leave the selection of plugins to default and click OK. The next time you load Reader, you’ll notice it starts up much faster.



Adobe Reader Speed-Up

Alternatively, you could try Foxit PDF reader—it’s fast and light on system resources, looks quite similar to Reader, and loads PDFs fast. You can find it on all *Digit* CDs.

Beyond Word

Q We are a group of college students. We want to start a small newsletter type of publication for our college. I feel MS Word is inadequate as a page layout software. Could you recommend a better software that is also easy to use? I don’t mind paying.

Niranjan Joshi

A If you are still looking for a dedicated program with which to create your newsletter, PagePlus is a good program available from www.serif.com. You can also visit www.freerisef-software.com where you can find and download several older versions of Serif programs free of charge. One of these free programs is PagePlus 5, which should definitely meet your requirements. You can design your page layouts from scratch or use one of the inbuilt templates to get started quickly. You can even try Microsoft Publisher, which will meet your needs if you don’t have large volumes of content.

Himem Harassment

Q I use Windows 98, and have been getting the following error message:
“The following file is missing or corrupted:
C:\WINDOWS\HIMEM.SYS
HIMEM.SYS is missing
Make sure that the file is in your Windows directory.
Windows has stopped. Press CTRL+ALT+DELETE to restart your computer.”

I am now unable to boot into Windows.

Pravin Dabhade

A To correct this problem, you’ll have to extract a new copy of Himem.sys from your Windows 98 CD. Boot from the Windows 98 CD or from the Windows 98 startup disk: insert the Windows 98 CD into the CD/DVD drive. Type in the following commands:

F: (assuming F is the letter of your CD/DVD drive)
CD\WIN98

extract /a /y /e /l c:\windows base4.cab himem.sys

Here, we’ve assumed that C:\Windows is the location where Windows 98 is installed. After the file has been extracted, restart your computer.

A Vanishing Act

Q I like to keep shortcuts on my Desktop to the Web sites I visit frequently. Some sites have their own logos, such as MSN’s butterfly, which makes it easy to identify them. But these icons periodically disappear, and are replaced with a standard Internet Explorer icon. How do I keep this from happening?

Sharad Mathur

A Web site designers can add a site-specific icon in two ways. One way is simple: They just include a file named favicon.ico in the root folder of the site. The other involves using a script and is less common. When you add a Favorite or create a URL shortcut, the special icon gets copied into your Temporary Internet Files folder (the browser cache). If you clear the cache, the icon will be lost. Even if you don’t,